

Entrepreneurship

In a world of accelerating change, where both challenges and opportunities abound, students need to learn how to live and work in an enterprising way, either as entrepreneurs who take the initiative to create new ventures or as enterprising individuals who apply their skills, attitudes, and abilities while working within the various organizations that contribute to our society. The need to be enterprising is further emphasized by the exponential growth of e-commerce and the economic opportunities it presents. Students will have opportunities to acquire the knowledge, skills, and attributes of entrepreneurs and enterprising employees by organizing an event, planning a school-based business, or completing a venture plan with an e-commerce component. Students will use these skills to learn how to live and work as creative problem solvers who welcome and successfully manage change.

Strands

Entrepreneurship: The Venture, Grade 11, College Preparation

- Enterprising People and Entrepreneurs
- Ideas and Opportunities for New Ventures
- The Benefits of a Venture Plan
- Developing and Completing a Venture Plan for the Proposed Business

Entrepreneurship: The Enterprising Person, Grade 11, Open

- The Changing Nature of the Workplace
- Entrepreneurship and the Enterprising Employee
- Enterprising Skills
- The Enterprising Experience: Planning and Organizing an Event

Entrepreneurship: Venture Planning in an Electronic Age, Grade 12, College Preparation

- E-Commerce and Venture Planning
- The Venture Concept
- Preparing for Start-up
- Targeting Customers
- Developing the Venture Plan

Entrepreneurship: The Enterprising Person, Grade 11, Open

(BDP3O)

This course examines the importance of enterprising employees in today's changing business environment. Students will learn about the skills and attributes of enterprising employees, the distinguishing features of their work environments, and the challenges and rewards of becoming an enterprising person. Students will also have an opportunity to demonstrate and develop enterprising skills by planning and organizing a school or community event.

Prerequisite: None

The Changing Nature of the Workplace

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the major factors affecting the labour market;
- analyse the changing nature of work and the workplace;
- analyse the characteristics of work environments that promote enterprising behaviour and identify the factors that influence the creation of such an environment;
- demonstrate an understanding of the range of employability skills and how these are affected by the changing nature of work.

Specific Expectations

Factors Affecting the Labour Market

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify, through research, the factors that can influence the demand for various types of labour and labour skills (e.g., level of sales, production methods, use of technology, cost of labour substitutes, type of product produced);
- identify the factors that determine the supply of labour (e.g., the size, age, and education of the population; the type of work available; immigration; the accessibility of appropriate training programs; the mobility of workers);
- describe the characteristics of the Canadian labour force (e.g., education, training, productivity, technological expertise, wage rates, unionization).
- analyse and interpret local labour-market statistics to determine the number and types of jobs available;
- assess current trends in the labour market (e.g., working at home, contract work, part-time work, self-employment);
- describe ways in which the changing nature of work has affected business (e.g., savings associated with using part-time and contract labour; increasing investments in information and communication technology).

The Enterprising Work Environment

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify the factors within the control of an employer or manager that encourage an enterprising spirit among employees (e.g., method of planning and organizing work, management style, leadership qualities, emphasis on the team approach, decentralized control, delegation of power);
- describe job features that would attract enterprising employees (e.g., opportunities for promotion, profit sharing, stock purchase plans, rewards for individual initiative, productivity bonuses, an innovative and exciting environment);

Changes in the Workplace

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the factors that are changing the Canadian workplace (e.g., new technology, competition, globalization, e-commerce) and explain how these factors may affect a person's career path;
- identify and describe the different types of labour required in the changing workplace (e.g., skilled, semi-skilled, unskilled, professional);

- analyse economic conditions that encourage the development of an enterprising workplace (e.g., global competition and innovation, pressures for increased productivity).

Employability Skills

By the end of this course, students will:

- explain how specific types of businesses require specific types of employees (e.g., automotive industry requiring tool and die makers, welders; software industry requiring engineers, programmers);
- compare the advantages and disadvantages of being paid by the hour, by salary, by commission, and on a contract basis from the standpoint of the employer and the employee;
- identify and describe employability skills required in today's workplace (e.g., Human Resources and Social Development Canada [HRSDC] essential skills);
- evaluate their employability skills by conducting a self-assessment (e.g., self-inventory test at TOWES [Test of Workplace Essential Skills] website);
- explain how a person's level of education can affect his or her employability.

Entrepreneurship and the Enterprising Employee

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify and describe the characteristics and contributions of an entrepreneur and the factors affecting successful entrepreneurship;
- assess the attitudes and attributes possessed by an enterprising employee;
- explain how enterprising employees react to situations of uncertainty and risk;
- analyse the potential benefits of an employee's enterprising attitudes and attributes to both the employee and the employer.

Specific Expectations

Entrepreneurial Characteristics and Factors Affecting Successful Entrepreneurship

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify the attitudes, attributes, and skills common to many entrepreneurs;
- identify some Canadian and local entrepreneurs and describe their achievements;
- describe the barriers that various entrepreneurs (e.g., women, people with disabilities, Aboriginal peoples, new immigrants, people from various ethnocultural minorities) have faced in the past and the factors that are contributing to their success today (e.g., funding, education, changing attitudes, mentoring);
- describe the roles of entrepreneurs that benefit communities and society (e.g., agents of change, creators of jobs and wealth, role models of ethical behaviour, advocates for community development).

Attitudes and Attributes of Enterprising Employees

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify the various factors that motivate people to work (e.g., need for food, shelter, clothing; interest in the field of work; desire to make a contribution to society);
- define the term “enterprising employee” and explain the factors that motivate enterprising workers (e.g., desire for personal control, personal achievement);

- describe the personal attributes that make it possible to work in enterprising ways (e.g., self-confidence, creativity, willingness to work hard, willingness to take risks);
- analyse the ways in which enterprising people use failure as a learning experience;
- compare the characteristics of an enterprising employee with those of an entrepreneur.

Reactions to Uncertainty and Risk

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe ways in which enterprising employees can approach new or uncertain situations (e.g., with a positive, open mind; with a view to discovering new opportunities);
- describe the risks that enterprising employees may be willing to take (e.g., rejection of ideas, responsibility for outcomes);
- specify ways in which enterprising employees manage risk (e.g., communicate and plan effectively, build a team, tap expertise, develop prototypes, consult);
- explain why enterprising people are willing to accept the risks associated with enterprising behaviour in the workplace (e.g., desire to create, make a difference, obtain job satisfaction, earn more money).

The Contributions of Enterprising Employees

By the end of this course, students will:

- explain why an employer may or may not value the contributions of an enterprising employee;
- describe how enterprising employees can apply creative or innovative thinking to make a business more competitive;
- brainstorm ideas on how students can be enterprising in a classroom setting;
- describe contributions that enterprising employees can make in the workplace, and compare the contributions of various enterprising employees;
- explain how improved productivity can benefit both the company and its employees.

Enterprising Skills

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- assess the skills of an enterprising employee;
- assess the extent to which they have developed enterprising skills;
- analyse activities and experiences to identify those that develop enterprising skills in managing risks, using creative-thinking and problem-solving techniques, and sharing ideas.

Specific Expectations

Assessing Skills

By the end of this course, students will:

- explain the nature and importance of critical-analysis, problem-solving, and creative-thinking skills for an enterprising employee;
- describe ways in which a person can continuously develop enterprising skills;
- describe the self-management skills that are important to an enterprising employee (e.g. organizational and time-management skills, ability to balance work with other aspects of life).

Assessing Personal Progress

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the ways in which their interests, accomplishments, relationships with others, and leisure activities have helped develop their enterprising skills;
- analyse their enterprising skills to identify those they have developed and those they should develop;
- distinguish between enterprising attitudes and attributes that are innate and those that can be learned;
- assess the personal rewards of becoming an enterprising individual.

Identifying Opportunities for Developing Enterprising Skills

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify opportunities within the school curriculum to apply and develop enterprising skills (e.g., career mentoring, work experience, cooperative education, seminars, group activities);
- identify co-curricular opportunities that can help develop enterprising skills (e.g., school teams and clubs, student council);
- assess opportunities to develop enterprising attributes and skills through part-time jobs;
- identify opportunities to participate in volunteer community-service programs that require enterprising skills;
- compare specific entry-level jobs in terms of the opportunities they present to apply and develop enterprising skills (e.g., as illustrated in the occupational profiles at the HRSDC website).

The Enterprising Experience: Planning and Organizing an Event

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- generate and evaluate ideas for an event in the school or the community and identify a realistic event to plan and organize;
- analyse the resources required to plan the event;
- create an appropriate advertising and promotional plan for the event;
- demonstrate enterprising skills by participating in the planning and execution of the event.

Specific Expectations

Generating Ideas for an Event

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify potential opportunities within the school or community for an event (e.g., upcoming holidays, student activity days, needs of local charities);
- apply creative-thinking strategies (e.g., brainstorming) to generate possible ideas for the event (e.g., dance, car wash, fundraiser, field trip);
- select the best idea for the event by applying criteria (e.g., potential dates, competing events, financial feasibility) in a decision-making model.

Resource Analysis for the Event

By the end of this course, students will:

- determine the materials, supplies, and equipment required for the event;
- determine the human resource requirements for the event (e.g., roles and responsibilities of organizers; committees for promotions, tickets, finance, production);
- determine the financial resources required for the event (e.g., cost of materials, supplies, and equipment);
- identify possible sources of funding for the event (e.g., student contributions, student council, business sponsorships, local service groups);
- determine a fair price to charge for admission for the event.

The Advertising and Promotional Plan

By the end of this course, students will:

- compare the costs and benefits of various ways of promoting the event (e.g., publicity through the local media or word of mouth; promotions such as coupons or giveaways);
- compare the costs and benefits of various forms of advertising for the event (e.g., flyers, school and community newspapers, local radio stations, local cable channels, school website);
- create appropriate advertising and promotions for the event;
- develop an advertising and promotional timeline for the event (e.g., identify lead time for media, production time for printed materials, time needed for distribution).

Organizing and Executing the Event

By the end of this course, students will:

- prepare a duty roster (e.g., timetable, staff list, agenda) outlining staff/volunteer responsibilities for the day of the event and a back-up plan if the event is weather dependent;
- apply ethical practices, socially responsible actions, and correct safety procedures at all stages of organizing and executing the event;

- generate an event plan, using appropriate software and effective application of business communication techniques (e.g., presentations, business reports, business forms, charts);
- perform the tasks necessary to execute the event;
- assess and evaluate the event (e.g., Was it well attended? Was it worthwhile? How could it be improved?);
- assess the enterprising skills that were developed in executing the event.